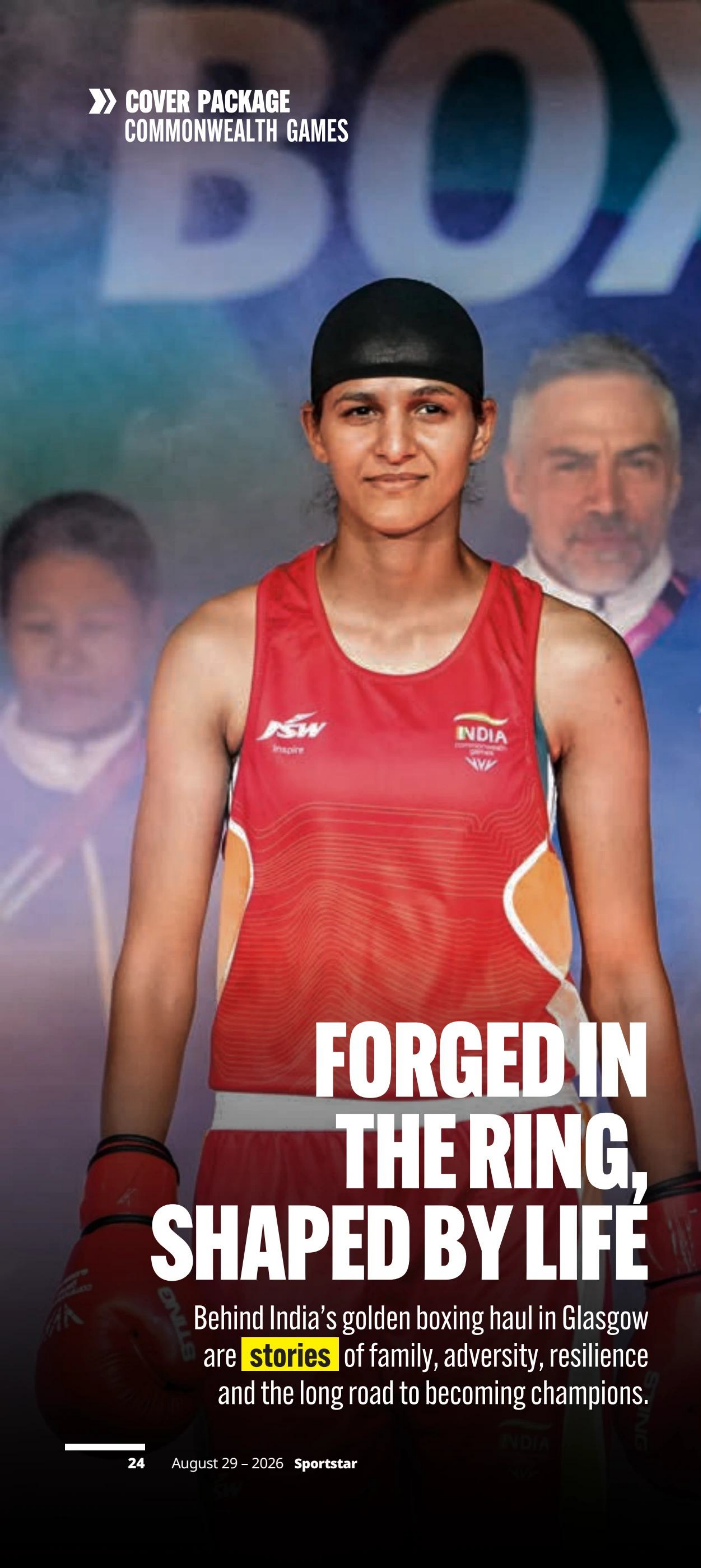


A full-page photograph of boxer Jaismine Lamboria. She is wearing a red boxing singlet with 'ASW Inspire' and 'INDIA commonwealth games' logos, a black headband, and red boxing gloves. She is standing in front of a blurred background featuring the Commonwealth Games logo and other people.

FORGED IN THE RING, SHAPED BY LIFE

Behind India's golden boxing haul in Glasgow are **stories** of family, adversity, resilience and the long road to becoming champions.

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The first thing Jaismine Lamboria wanted to do after returning from Glasgow to her home in Bhiwani, in Haryana, last week, was tuck into a bowl of *churma*.

"*Maa ke haath ka churma*," she clarifies. The sweet, greasy, crumbly dish of ghee, jaggery and *roti* made by her mother isn't the sort of food that normally features in the carefully regulated diet of an elite boxer. Away at camps and competitions, Jaismine had been craving the treat. "I'm eating it after three months," she tells *Sportstar*.

It's *churma* and other *ghar ka khana* (home food) that's occupying Jaismine's mind these days. That's because the 25-year-old is already preparing for her time back in training. Home-cooked meals will soon be a thing of the past. So too will be the gold medal she's just won at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow (**facing page**).

The medal didn't come easy — she had to beat two-time Olympian and reigning Commonwealth Games champion Michaela Walsh in the final. But Jaismine has her perspective. "Right now after Glasgow I'm feeling really happy. It feels good to have done so much for India. But that happiness will last only a few days. Then it will go away and I'll return to training at the women's national boxing camp next week. Already my mind has started to go on what I have to do," she says.

The gold medal carries more meaning than she lets on. It's a major milestone in her journey as a boxer.

Stellar show: Jaismine Lamboria was one of seven Indian boxers to win gold at the 2026 Commonwealth Games. PTI